



Audio Engineer Guide Book

2026

Final Email Checklist

- All Ideas should be properly arranged bounced and sent to the client and A&R
- **Writing Sessions ONLY go to the A&R.**
- Session reports should be sent to Joi, Torch Session Report Email & Sessions A&R
- This includes one word ideas, EVERYTHING should be bounced so the A&R knows what was worked on
- If Beat packs were delivered during the session, ensure the beat pack is also sent to the A&R of the session
- **At the end of every session, send ALL bounces to bounces@torchatl.com**

Room Etiquette

Engineers control the room

- As the engineer of the room, you are responsible for maintaining the vibe of the session
- We expect you to use your customer service skills
 - When a session arrives, ask them if they need anything i.e. Keyboards, ice, or any lights adjusted
 - Clients usually need the Wifi password, make sure to point out the Wifi display card
- Use the Group-me to stay in contact with Hands-on for any room needs
- If any equipment malfunctions even for a short while, make sure to inform Management of the error that occurred during the session

File / Session Names

This is Important for finding files and keeping credits correct

- (Artist/Client Name) x (Date) x (Studio Suite) x (Engineer Name) x (Song Name)
- Every session created should reflect like the following example
- **RNBFOEMOB x 02.18.25 x Motown x PR x Water**
- It's also helpful to do Save As when the bounce is named and renaming
- When working with a Writing Session include the artist the WS was for:
- **Kehalani WS x 02.18.25 x Underdogs x Darius x This Love**

Bounce Protocol

- Ensure bounces are correctly named: (Song Name) x (Artist) x (Date)
- **Blessings x Dejhha x 02.12.25**
- In the Metadata please adjust the name to only the song name, the artist in the artist line along with the producer if known.
- **DO NOT LEAVE the full bounce name in the metadata.**
- All Work must be bounced even partial ideas. The A&R needs to know what was worked on in their session

Bounce settings: WAV (BWF), PCM Uncompressed, Interleaved, 24 Bit, 48 kHz. MP3: 320kbit/s CBR. File destination: Bounced Files/ within session folder.

Bounce Protocol (cont.)

- When working producer sessions, ensure all beats worked on are received, notated in the session report, and sent to the A&R
- When bouncing out a hook idea, if the hook came after a verse first, move the hook to the beginning of the record. At no point should a hook only bounce open up with an empty verse unless otherwise told by the A&R or artist.
- When bouncing out ACAs, ensure the BPM and the key is added to the file name

Saving Files / Sessions

- Please encourage clients to back up their sessions on their drives.
- Ensure Label sessions are fully secured on our drives.
- If running low on space on the drives, you can save in the documents folder
- **Never save any files to the Desktop or the Downloads folder.**
- **DO NOT send Writing Sessions creatives booked by labels, Joi, or other A&Rs any sessions files or bounces unless told by the sessions A&R or studio management.**

Session Reports

- Engineer is responsible for completing session reports with ALL applicable details to the best of your knowledge. If you have any questions ask management
- **These reports will be checked daily, please ensure all information is correct**
- Engineer is responsible for emailing session reports from the shared engineer's Gmail account to the A&R of the session/the Session Contact, the Torch Management email
- If any space is filled with "N/A". Please put into the notes the reason, for example, if "N/A" is in the producer section add to the notes: "The beat has no tag and was not given by an in room producer, not 100% sure on producer."

Session Report

Properly filled example ->

- Ensure the session start and end time reflects the time booked for the session. If the session goes longer with management approval, please note the session was extended in the notes.
- Please note if a song was finished, started, or just edited in the notes.
- Ensure the session type is accurate
- The engineer's name provided is the one used for credits

Properly filled WS example ->

- **Ensure Every writer is notated in**
- For Writing Sessions Session reports are a very crucial part of file keeping
- the writers column.
- If multiple producers were used ensure its labeled which songs they produced.

Microphone Placement

- Microphones with a properly functioning shock mount should be hung upside down.

If the shock mount is damaged and there is no backup, leave the mic upright.

Microphones are positioned upside down so the heat dispersion will not rise into the diaphragm.

Pop filter should be positioned roughly one dollar bills length away from the mic.

This will aid in full and round vocal captures

Being too close can lead to distortion and affects perception

Microphone Use

Correct forms of use for certain microphones

- Most Microphones we have here require Phantom Power '+48'.
- Please ensure the mic currently in use in the booth is one that requires phantom power prior to turning on the pre amp.
- Improper use of phantom power can lead to a blown diaphragm
- **If you are unsure, contact Anthony before applying Phantom Power**
- Our Sony C-800s are available by request, and management approval.
- **DO NOT USE PHANTOM POWER WITH THE VACUUM MICS**
- Improper use of the mics can lead to losing engineer bookings
- **If another microphone is used, secure the old mic in equipment closet**
- **ONLY THE MIC IN USE SHOULD BE IN THE BOOTH**

Room Setup / Cleanup

- Arrive 15 minutes before your session to ensure the room is properly set up, turned on, and ready for recording.
 - This includes testing audio and checking mic signal, if you are unable to troubleshoot any problems, contact management
- Session wraps include cleaning off your engineering desk, returning any equipment (keyboards, headphones) to the equipment closet.
 - **Engineers MUST return equipment at the end of sessions**
 - **Interns are not allowed in the equipment closet. Only management and qualified engineers have access to the equipment closet**
- If an intern isn't staffed Engineers are responsible for tidying up and removing the trash from the room

Assistant Engineering

Assisting is your opportunity to indulge in the wealth of information our engineers can provide you.

Gain experience on how to run a session

- Maintaining vibe in the room
- Building proper song structure and professional sound with the talent
- Ensuring the client is taken care of
- As an assistant to the engineer, you are also assigned the room itself

Any runs/errands are done by the room's assistant engineer

Helping with cleaning and setup at the beginning and end of the session

Important Emails

admin@torchstudios.com

joi.coleman@atlanticrecords.com

bounces@torchatl.com (ALL session bounces go here)

A&R or Session Contact emails will be provided with session booking, if unsure contact Management for the correct information